

40 ETHICS OF RASULLUAH
SAW

ETHICS



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Beautiful Ethics and Traditions of Rasulullah (sall- Allāhu ta‘ālā ‘alayhi wa sallam)

Fourty Noble Characteristics and Customs

1. His Supreme Virtues and Qualities

Rasulullah’s knowledge, insight, understanding, certainty (yaqīn), intelligence, wisdom, generosity, humility, gentleness, compassion, patience, effort, patriotism, loyalty, trustworthiness, bravery, majesty, eloquence, beauty, chastity, modesty, zuhd, and taqwā surpassed those of all other Prophets. He forgave harms from both friends and enemies. Even at Uhud, when his blessed face was wounded and his tooth was broken, he prayed:

“O Rabb, forgive them, for they do not know.”

2. His Compassion for Animals

He showed great mercy even to animals. He gave water to them with his own hands, held the bowl for them until they were satisfied, and wiped his horse’s face and eyes.

3. His Humility and Manner of Sitting

He answered every caller with “Labbayk.” He never stretched his feet in front of others. He often sat on his knees. When mounted, he would offer space behind him to those walking.

4. His Equality with Others

He never considered himself superior. During a journey, when a meal needed preparation, he took responsibility to gather firewood, saying: **“Allah does not like a person who separates himself from his companions.”**

5. His Simplicity in Gatherings

When joining his Companions, he sat wherever there was an empty spot. When people stood for him, he said:

“Do not stand for me as others do. I am only a human. I eat as you eat and sit when I am tired.”

6. His Character With Servants

He sat in humble postures, sometimes wrapping his arms around his knees. He treated servants equally in food and clothing, never striking or rebuking anyone. Anas ibn Malik—who served him for ten years—said:

“He never said ‘uff’ to me nor asked why I did or did not do something.”

7. His Self-Sufficiency

He patched his own clothes, milked his sheep, fed his animals, carried his own goods, and cared for animals during travel—sometimes alone, sometimes with help.

8. His Respect for Servants

If a servant came to call him, he would walk with him, following the custom of Madinah.

9. Visiting the Sick & Attending Funerals

He visited the sick, including unbelievers and hypocrites, to soften hearts. After Fajr, he asked:

“Is there a sick person we can visit?”

If someone had passed away, he assisted with washing, shrouding, prayer, and burial.

10. His Care for the Companions

If he did not see a Companion for three days, he inquired about him. He prayed for travelers and visited those present in the city.

11. His Greeting

He initiated salām to every Muslim he met.

12. His Mode of Transport

He rode camels, horses, mules, and donkeys, and sometimes seated others behind him.

13. His Service to Others

He served guests and companions, saying:
“The leader of a people is the one who serves them.”

14. His Manner of Smiling

He never laughed loudly; he smiled gently, sometimes showing his blessed teeth.

15. His Thoughtfulness

He appeared thoughtful, calm, and spoke little—beginning speech with a smile.

16. His Clear and Purposeful Speech

He never spoke useless words. When needed, he spoke briefly, clearly, and sometimes repeated statements three times.

17. His Gentle Humor

He made light-hearted jokes with children, women, elders, and strangers—yet never forgot Allah even for a moment.

18. His Majesty

People could not gaze at him due to his awe. When someone trembled, he said:

“Do not fear. I am not a king. I am the son of a woman who ate dried meat.”

19. His Accessibility

He had no guards or gatekeepers—anyone could approach him freely.

20. His Modesty

He was shy and avoided staring at faces. He never confronted anyone with their faults, instead saying:

“Why do some people do such a thing?”

21. His Fear of Allah

Despite being beloved to Allah, he said:

“I am the one who knows Allah best and fears Him most.”

He cried during prayer, supplicated during storms, and sought beneficial winds.

22. His Courage

His bravery was unmatched. At Hunayn, when many fled, he stood firm and caused the enemy to retreat.

23. His Strength

He defeated renowned wrestlers like Rukāna multiple times, causing them to accept Islam due to his truthfulness and strength.

24. His Generosity

He gave away entire herds of animals and wealth without keeping anything for himself. Many embraced Islam seeing his generosity.

25. His Eating Habits

He never refused food. He ate simply—often barley bread, dates, vinegar, milk, fruits, and vegetables. Sometimes days passed with no cooked food at home.

26. His Fasting

If no food was available when he came home, he would begin fasting.

27. His Manners of Eating

He ate on the ground, not at high tables, using his right hand, and began with “Bismillah.”

28. His Appreciation of Food

He preferred mutton, broth, pumpkin, honey, dates, milk, melons, grapes, cucumbers, and cool water.

29. His Drinking Etiquette

He drank water in three breaths, saying “Alhamdulillah” at the end.

30. His Clothing

He wore simple, lawful garments—often white, sometimes green, red, or black. He wore shirts (qamīs), wool, cotton, cloaks, and turbans, especially on Fridays and Eid.

31. His Turban and Headwear

He wore turbans of moderate size, sometimes without a skullcap.

32. His Hair

He kept hair to mid-ear length, sometimes longer, and oiled it regularly.

33. His Fragrance

He used musk, camphor, and other pleasant scents on his head and hands.

34. His Bedding

His bed was leather stuffed with date fiber. He rejected softer woolen beds, preferring simplicity.

35. His Beard

He kept a beard of a handful's length, trimming the excess.

36. His Personal Care

He applied kohl three times to each eye at night. His home contained mirrors, combs, scissors, miswaks, and grooming tools.

37. His Preference for the Right Side

He began actions with the right hand—except cleanliness, which he performed with the left.

38. His Love for Odd Numbers

He preferred odd-numbered actions whenever possible.

39. His Night Worship

He slept after ‘Ishā, then prayed during the night until Fajr. He slept on his right side with his hand under his cheek.

40. His Response to Sadness

In sorrow, he touched his beard and reflected. He also turned to prayer, saying:

“The coolness of my eyes is in the prayer.”